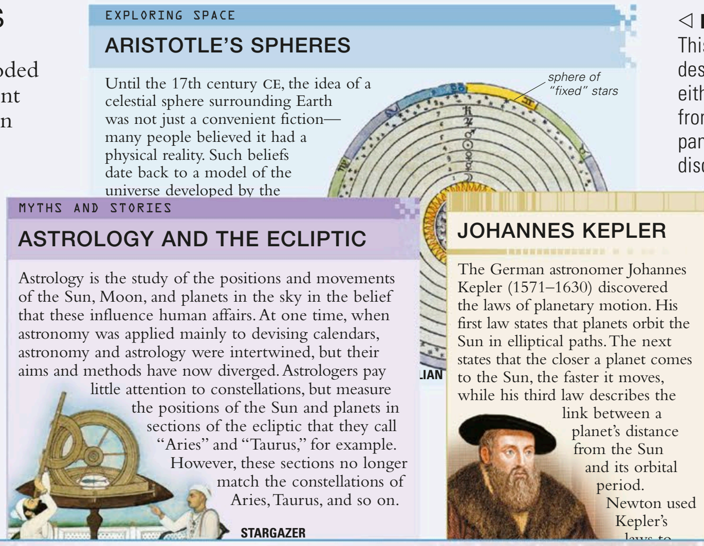
THEMED PANELS

Three types of color-coded panels are used to present a more detailed focus on selected subjects. These panels appear both on explanatory pages and in feature profiles.



◁ EXPLORING SPACE
This type of feature is used to describe the study of space either from Earth's surface or from spacecraft. Individual panels describe particular discoveries or investigations.

MYTHS AND STORIES ▷
As well as being studied scientifically, objects in the night sky have featured in myths, superstitions, and folklore, which form the subject of this type of panel.

◁ BIOGRAPHY
Profiles of notable astronomers and pioneers of spaceflight, as well as a brief summary of their achievements, appear in this type of panel.

CONTRIBUTORS

Martin Rees General editor

Robert Dinwiddie What Is the Universe?, The Beginning and End of the Universe, The View From Earth, The Solar System, The Milky Way

Philip Eales The Milky Way

David Hughes The Solar System

Iain Nicolson Glossary

Ian Ridpath The View From Earth, The Night Sky

Robin Scagell The View from Earth

Giles Sparrow The Solar System, Beyond the Milky Way

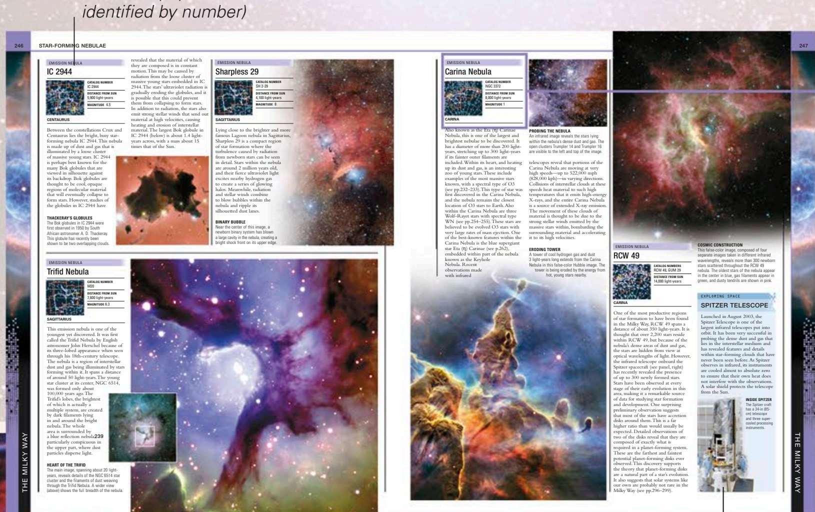
Pam Spence The Milky Way

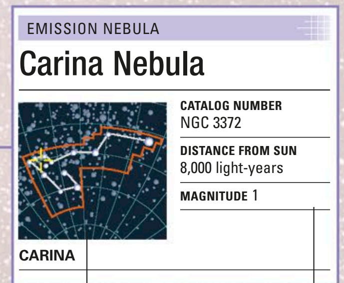
Carole Stott The Solar System

Kevin Tildsley The Milky Way

David Rothery The Solar System

name or astronomical catalog number of feature (features without a popular name are identified by number)

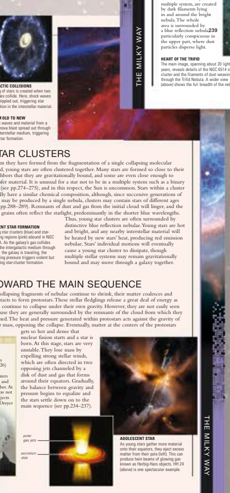




locator map shows constellation in which feature can be found and its position within the constellation

table of summary information (varies between sections)

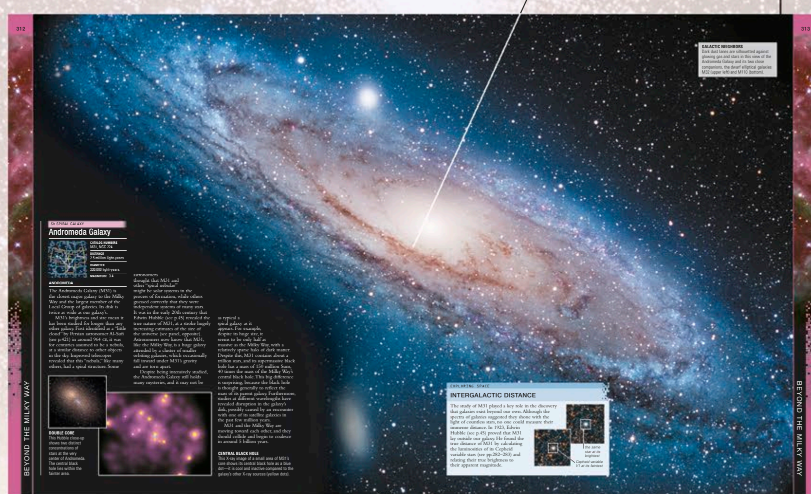
selected features are described in double-page feature profiles



△ FEATURE PROFILES
Throughout the Guide to the Universe, introductory pages are often followed by profiles of a selection of specific objects. For example, the introduction to star formation (left) is followed by profiles of actual star-forming regions in the Milky Way (above).

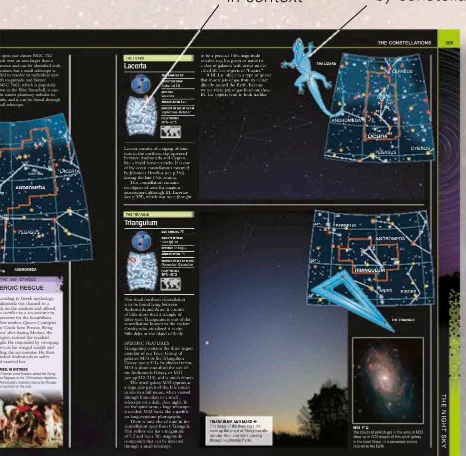
themed panel (see above)

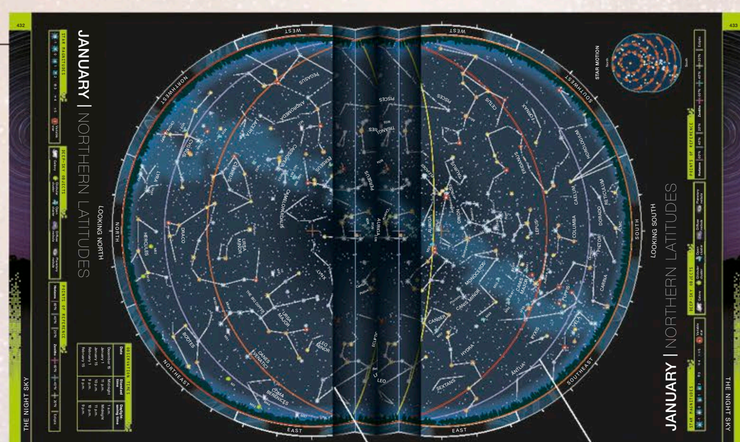
BEYOND THE MILKY WAY ▷
This section looks at features found beyond our own galaxy, including other galaxies and galaxy clusters and superclusters, the largest known structures in the universe.



locator shows constellation in context

artwork of figure depicted by constellation





△ MONTHLY SKY GUIDE
This section includes two charts for each month of the year for observers in northern and southern latitudes. The section is described in more detail on pp.428–429.

chart on this page shows view looking north, with view to south on facing page

lines on chart show reference points for observers at different latitudes

THE GREEK ALPHABET

Astronomers use a convention for naming some stars in which Greek letters are assigned to stars according to their brightness. These letters appear on some of the charts in this book.

α	alpha	ν	nu
β	beta	ξ	xi
γ	gamma	ο	omicron
δ	delta	π	pi
ε	epsilon	ρ	rho
ζ	zeta	σ	sigma
η	eta	τ	tau
θ	theta	υ	upsilon
ι	iota	φ	phi
κ	kappa	χ	chi
λ	lambda	ψ	psi
μ	mu	ϖ	omega